What is Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) and how can we tap its opportunities whilst mitigating its risks?

What is Generative AI (Gen AI)? What opportunities does it present?

*'Artificial intelligence (AI) is **rapidly changing** the way **children and adolescents play, communicate, and learn.** While it has potential to help solve complex problems, **AI presents both significant opportunities and notable risks concerning child well-being**' – [1]UNICEF (2023)*

While AI is a type of technology that allows computers to perform tasks that usually require human thinking, Gen AI is a type of AI that is probabilistic and predicts the most likely answer.

GenAI presents opportunities for learning:

- Supports learning through personalised and instant feedback
- Assists with ideation
- Provides an avenue to improve digital literacy, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills

[1]UNICEF (2023), *Generative AI: Risks and Opportunities for Children. Wow can we empower and protect children in the face of Artificial Intelligence?*, Innocenti – Global Office of Research and Foresight, https://www.unicef.org/innocenti/generative-ai-risks-and-opportunities-children (accessed on 22 July 2024).

What are the limitations and potential risks of GenAI?

We recognise that GenAI might pose risks, especially when it is not used effectively:

- May give inaccurate or biased answers
- May create tendency for over-reliance when overused
- May pose risks if personal information is shared
- Probabilistic and predicts the most likely answer – it can sound confident even when it is wrong
- Responds like a person, but it does not truly understand or experience emotions.

About 1 in 2 teens would trust AI-generated news story to the same extent or more than one written by a human.[2]

[1]Common Sense (2025), *Nearly 3 in 4 Teens Have Used AI Companions, New National Survey Finds,* https://www.commonsensemedia.org/press-releases /nearly-3-in-4-teens-have-used-ai-companions-new-national-survey-finds (accessed on 23 October)
[2]UNICEF, *The risky new world of tech's friendliest bots AI companions and children*, https://www.unicef.org/innocenti/stories/risky-new-world-techs-friendliest-bots
[3]Parents, More Kids Are Turning to AI Companions—And It's Raising Red Flags https://www.parents.com/more-kids-are-turning-to-ai-companions-and-its-raising-red-flags-11790959#toc-how--why-kids-are-using-ai-companions-today

How should children interact with GenAI?

Parents should discourage your children from relying on AI Companions for social-emotional support, as this may pose challenges for their development:

- Children can become attached to AI Companions (e.g. chatbots) as trusted friends however this interaction poses a number of a concerns.
- It blurs the line between fantasy and reality and makes it harder to distinguish good advice from bad advice.
- Overuse of AI may limit opportunities for face-to-face communication, the development of one's empathy and emotional regulation.
- Over prolonged use, children may lack key socio-emotional competencies and struggle with real-world interactions[3] .

About 1 in 3 teens use AI companions for social interaction and find them as satisfying or more satisfying than those with real-life friends.[1]

[1]Common Sense (2025), *Nearly 3 in 4 Teens Have Used AI Companions, New National Survey Finds,* https://www.commonsensemedia.org/press-releases /nearly-3-in-4-teens-have-used-ai-companions-new-national-survey-finds (accessed on 23 October)
[2]UNICEF, *The risky new world of tech's friendliest bots AI companions and children*, https://www.unicef.org/innocenti/stories/risky-new-world-techs-friendliest-bots
[3]Parents, More Kids Are Turning to AI Companions—And It's Raising Red Flags https://www.parents.com/more-kids-are-turning-to-ai-companions-and-its-raising-red-flags-11790959#toc-how--why-kids-are-using-ai-companions-today

How will your child use AI to learn in school?

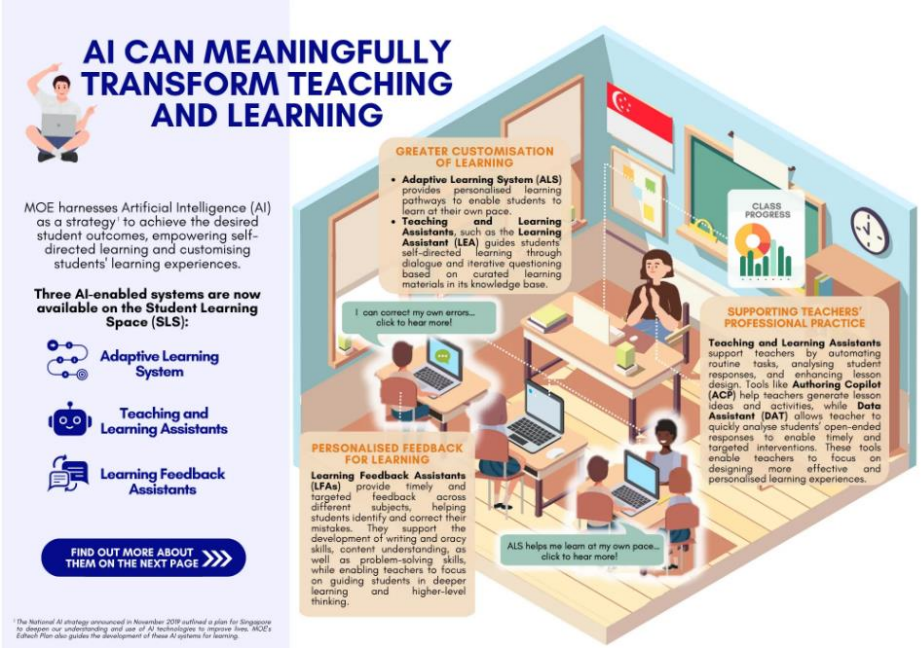
Find out how your child will use AI to learn and develop AI literacy through the school curriculum

Students will use GenAI to learn in an age-appropriate manner

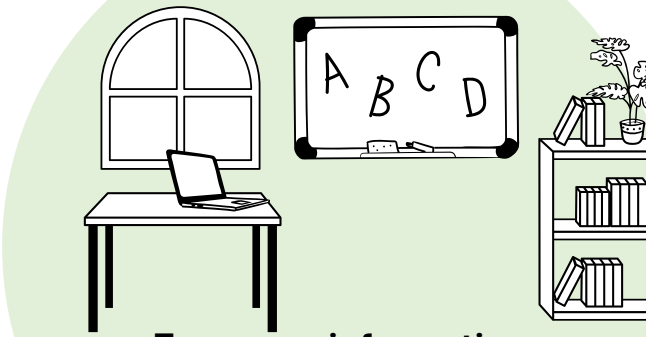
1. AI use for teaching and learning must be **age- and developmentally-appropriate.**
   - **Pri 1 to 3 students** will mainly engage in hands-on experiences, with **little or no** direct use of AI tools.
   - **Pri 4 to 6 students** will use AI tools occasionally with teacher supervision in class to support their learning.
2. There are safe and pedagogically sound AI tools available in the Singapore Student Learning Space (SLS). Students will use these tools when their teachers incorporate these tools within the assigned SLS modules.

Scan QR code to read more about SLS AI-enabled features!

Three AI-enabled systems in the Singapore Student Learning Space (SLS):



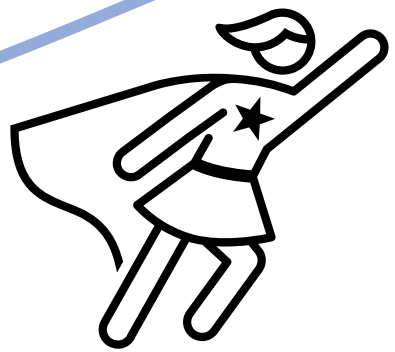
Students will develop AI literacy throughout primary school



To access information on MOE's NDLP

- Under MOE's National Digital Literacy Programme (NDLP), students will develop **9 digital competencies** under the **Find, Think, Apply, Create (FTAC)** Frame. (Scan QR code on the right)
- Students will develop AI literacy over their educational journey.

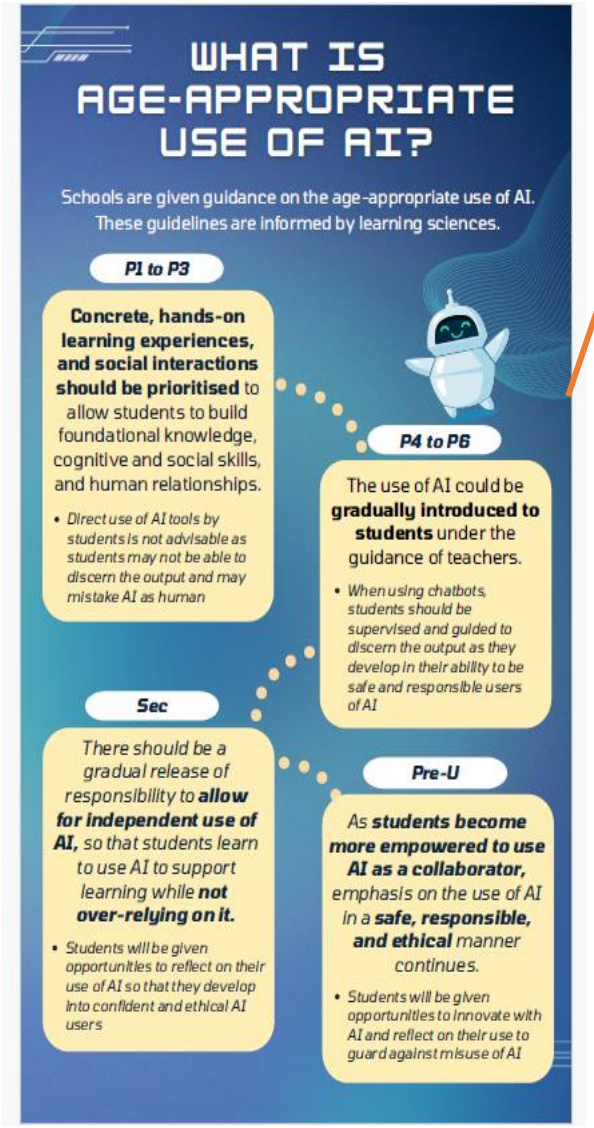
Lower primary students will learn to recognise that AI is present in our daily lives

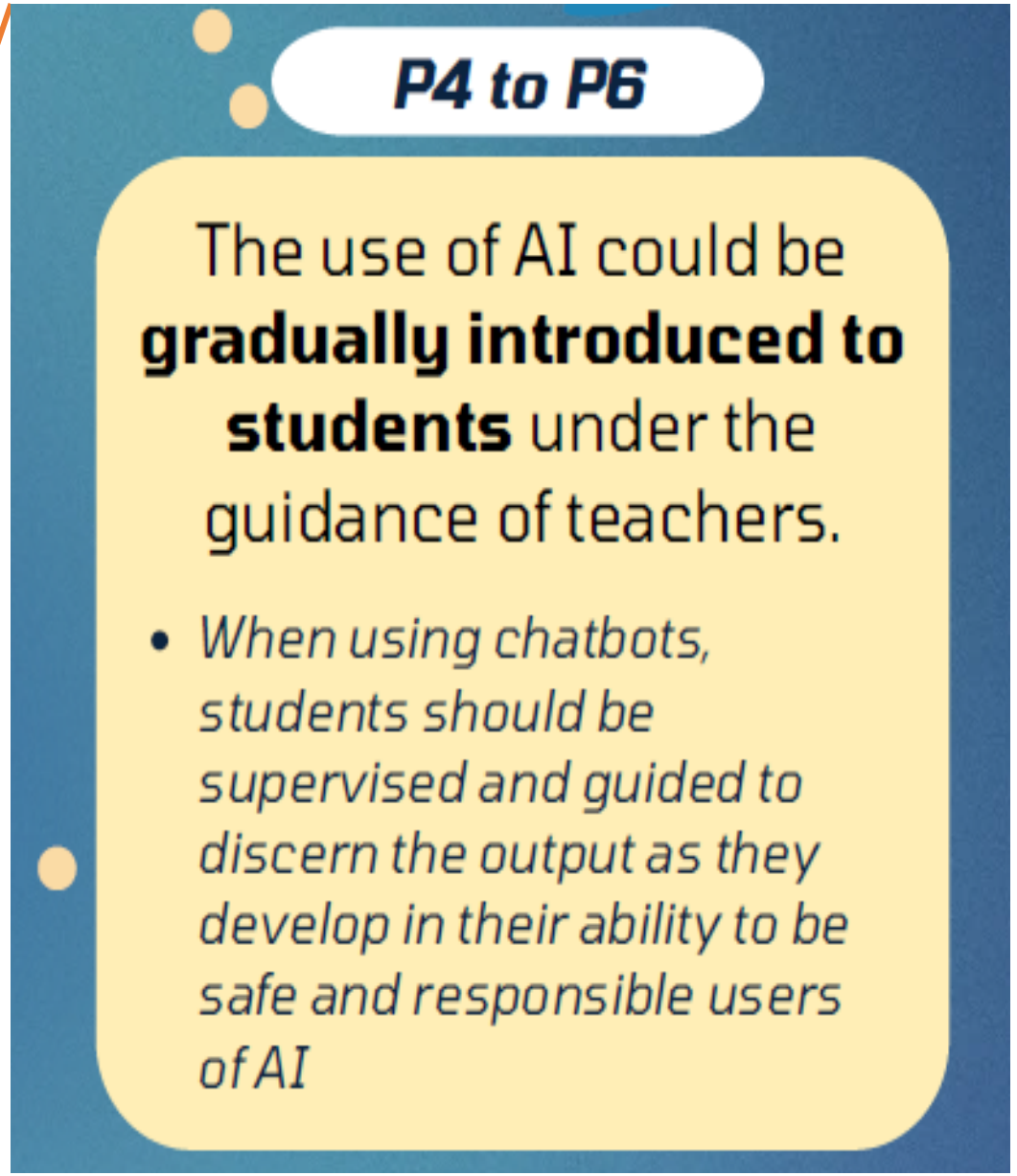


Upper primary students will learn about the risk of misinformation from AI output, that AI output may contain false information, and how some AI features (e.g. those in SLS) can support learning in a safe digital environment

Primary 4 to 6

How will your child use AI for his/her learning?





How Can Parents Partner Up with Schools on the use of AI & Edtech?

3 areas we can work together on to foster School-Home Partnership

1 Respectful Communication

2 Role Models

3 Real Connections

Our children do best when schools and parents work hand in hand to support them.

Respectful Communication

Listen, understand, and foster kind words and actions between you and your child

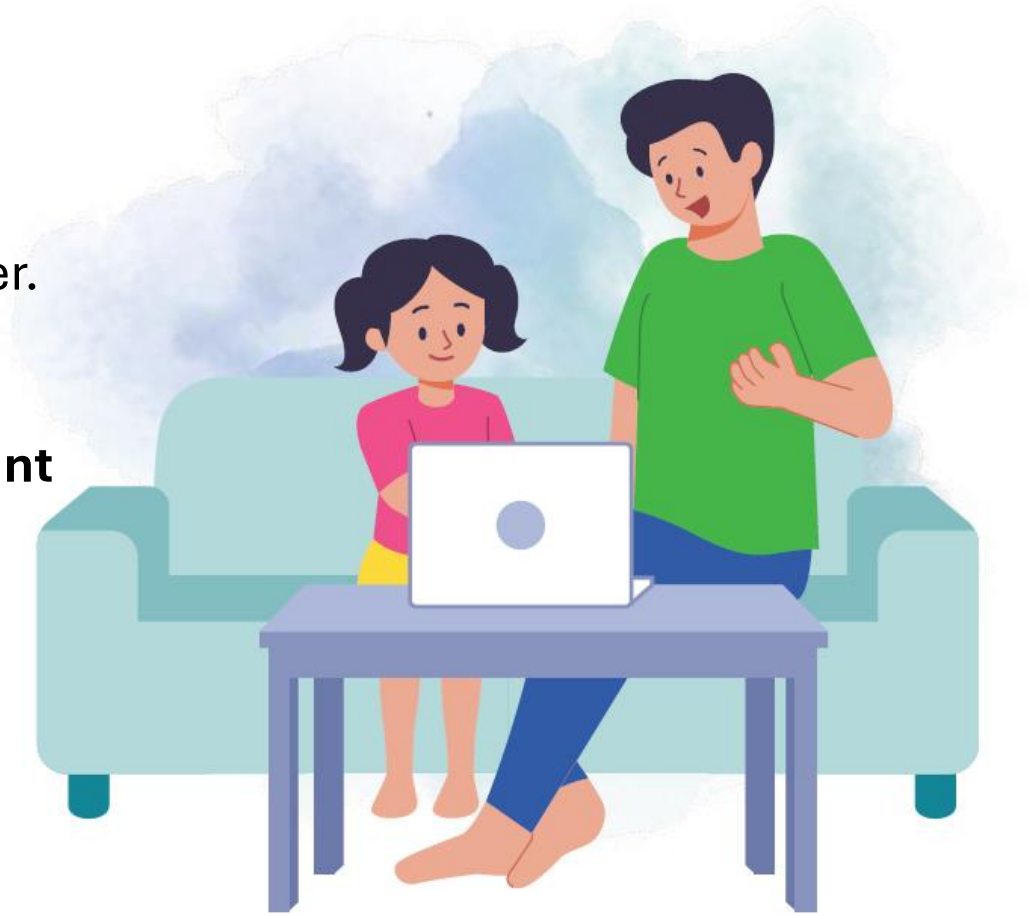
Have regular and genuine conversations with your child

- to better understand what they do online,
- how to stay safe,
- how to use technology in a responsible manner.

Communicate your actions and rationale.

- Let your child know **you care for them** and **want them to be safe online**.

Discuss with your child as you set parental controls to manage device use and stay safe online.



Role Models

As parents/guardians, you play a significant role in helping your child establish healthy digital habits, and learn to use technology in a positive and meaningful way.

Role model healthy use of devices and social media and good online behaviour for your child/ward

- E.g. parents/guardians not using devices during mealtimes, respectful online communication

Role modelling respectful conversations –

- Parents are in the best position to role model these skills through daily interactions with your child.
- **Listen to understand**, instead of listening to give advice and offer solutions.

Real Connections

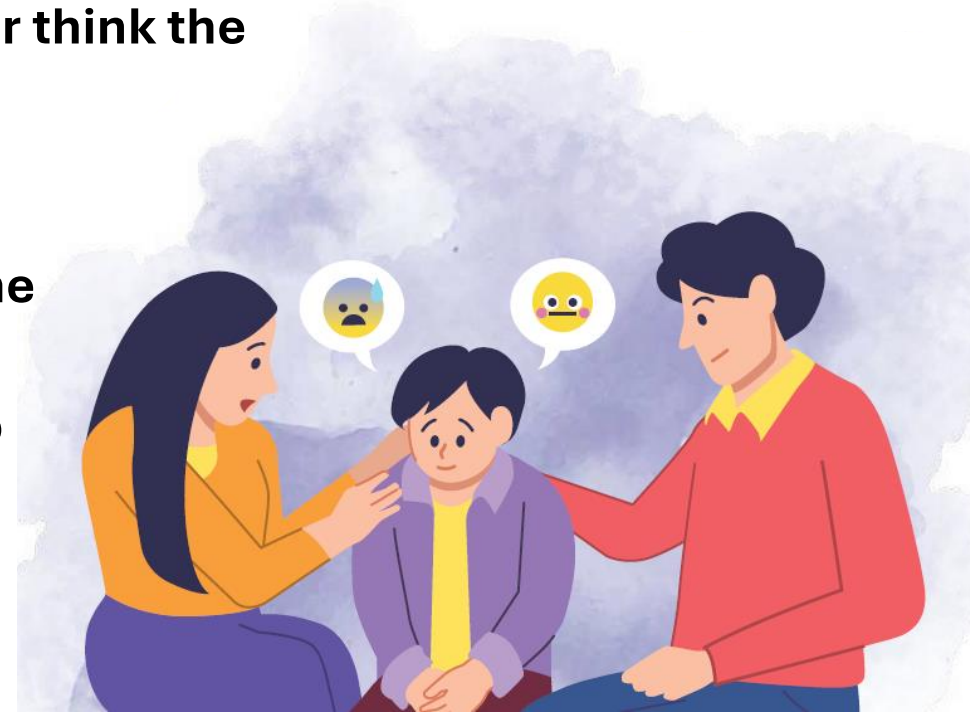
Cultivate strong relationships and healthy habits in this digital age

Provide a safe space for conversations

- Children may hesitate to share their true thoughts and feelings with their parents, as they may fear being judged or misunderstood.
- You can let your child know that it is **normal to feel or think the way they do**, and that **they can feel safe** expressing themselves with you.

Provide a balanced mix of engaging online and offline activities, at school and at home

- **Discuss and develop a timetable** with your child to moderate their time spent on screens.
- **Parental control settings** can be used to monitor and limit screen time as agreed with the child.



For age-appropriate AI –guidelines and tools, explore the following resources:

Using GenAI tools for Learning: A Parent's Guide

Parents who wish to learn more about generative AI and how they can support their child's responsible use of such tools can view this resource.

AI & Your Child Should parents guide or guard against AI?

Parents can view this resource to learn more about the guidelines for age-appropriate use of AI.

"Is AI Chatbot My Friend" Knowgets Video

Parents can view this video with their child to learn more about the dangers of being emotionally dependent on AI Chatbots.

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Other Useful Resources

Want to know more?

Additional Resources

SLS Onboarding Module for P1 Students

[SLS Onboarding Module for P1 Students]

SLS Onboarding Module for P4 Students

[SLS Onboarding Module for P4 Students]

Parents can encourage their child to go through the SLS onboarding module (for P1 and P4 students) which supports their child in learning how to use SLS to support his/her learning.

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